

Bylaws of the Utah Scots Guard

Revision History

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*"On the battlefield, a Guardsman is the fiercest of warriors
and the most benevolent of conquerors."*

1. Constitution

1.1 Constituted

The charter of the Utah Scots Guard is granted on _____, by the Lieutenant Grand Commander of the Ancient & Accepted Scottish Rite, Southern Jurisdiction of the United States of America, and Sovereign Grand Inspector General for the Orient of Utah, Illustrious Curtis N. Lancaster, 33°.

Guardsmen are hereafter bound to the edicts and regulations of this charter, and the authorities empowered herein.

1.2 Authority

The Utah Scots Guard is Constituted and authorized to enlist, commission, and advance Guardsmen, to support the Scottish Rite Learning Centers in the Orient of Utah, and to assist in the Scottish Rite Reunions in the Orient of Utah, and to complete such tasks and missions given it, by the Sovereign Grand Inspector General, the Chairman of the Membership Committee, and this Charter.

1.3 Documentation

The bylaws of this organization must be signed by the Permanent General, and the Most worshipful Grand Master of Free & Accepted Masons of Utah. These bylaws may be amended at any time by consensus of the Commandant and the Permanent General, with the acceptance of the Most Worshipful Grand Master of Free & Accepted Masons of Utah.

2. Mission and Organization

2.1 Mission

- Provide Service, Support and Assistance to the Scottish Rite Learning Centers of Utah in any manner as described or requested by the Scottish Rite Learning Centers, and the abilities of the Utah Scots Guard Permit.
- Provide Ceremonial escorts for all Scottish Rite Dignitaries within the Orient of Utah.
- In coordination with the Class Committee, assist with the registration and direction of the Class at Reunions.
- In coordination with the Director of the Work, provide ceremonial *tylers* for Reunions.
- Assist in arranging the furniture of the Lodge Room for Scottish Rite Business Meetings, and to act as Greeters for Business Meetings.
- To build leaders and leadership skills through hands-on experience, and increasing levels of responsibility.
- Perform such other duties as directed by the Permanent General, chairman of the Membership Committee, or the Commandant.

2.2 Components of the Utah Scots Guard

Utah Scots Guard, for the Orient of Utah, will be known as the Battalion of Utah Scots Guard (The Battalion). The Battalion is commanded by the Commandant of the Utah Scots Guard, who has full executive and command authority over all members and bodies of the Battalion. The Commandant reports directly to the Chairman of the Membership Committee for the Orient of Utah, and indirectly to the Permanent General of the Utah Scots Guard.

3. Customs and Courtesies

3.1 Saluting

While in Uniform, members of Utah Scots Guard are required to render a salute to all Officers of the Utah Scots Guard, any Supreme Grand Inspector General, Visiting Dignitaries, Offices & Ensigns that Require a Salute, and all Grand Master's of Freemasons.

3.2 Colors & Standards

The colors of The Battalion are described and outlined in the *Book of Words and Forms*.

3.3 Mottos & Slogan

The Motto for The Battalion shall be, *Deo Duce et Comitant Ferro*, which means, *With God my Guide, the Sword my Companion*.

3.4 Time

The start of the calendar year for the Battalion coincides with the Vernal Equinox, March 21st.

The Battalion will utilize a 24 Hour clock.

The official time of the Utah Scots Guard is always 10 minutes ahead of the standard local time, i.e. if an Formation is scheduled for 1700 hours, it will in reality occur at 1650 hours.

3.5 Voting

All voting, for all bodies of Guardsmen, is by show of hands. Secret ballots are expressly prohibited.

4.0 Membership, Rank Structure and Advancement

4.1 Entering Into The Battalion

Membership in the Utah Scots Guard is by invitation only, though one may announce their desire to become a member without fear of negative outcome. True application for membership shall come in the form of dedicated service to Freemasonry, the Ancient and Accepted Scottish Rite, and to all mankind.

Except where otherwise outlined in this document for Commissioned Officers, all Masters of the Royal Secret entering into this body will be enlisted, and start at the lowest enlisted rank.

The process to become a member follows:

Any Guardsman may recommend a Master of the Royal Secret for admission. Recommendations must be done in Formation or by writing to be read at Formation.

1. An election requires that all Temporary Battalion Officers, and 1/3 Battalion personnel with 25 miles of the Formation, be present for it to be considered valid, and binding. The Formation for Election must be communicated to all Guardsmen at least 30 days in advance of the Formation.
 - a. A negative outcome requires no communication back to the recommender, or the Brother. Nor does it permanently bar a Brother from the Battalion or the Company.
 - b. A successful outcome requires a report to be made to the Company, and to the Brother elected.
2. The newly elected Brother will report for duty at a Formation to be invested, take his Oath of Service, and sign the bylaws making him a fully empowered Guardsman.

4.2 Retired Personnel

Officers and Staff Non-Commissioned Officers who have honorably discharged their duties, or have retired from service, may continue to use their Rank/Title as desired and may, at proper occasion wear their Uniform.

Retired Personnel may not attend Formations, unless especially invited, and are never accorded a vote, or in the case of officers a Salute.

4.3 Discharges

Enlisted Personnel who have fulfilled their duties, and have requested to demit from the organization with a favorable opinion of this organization, are to be considered honorably discharged.

Commissioned Officers who have fulfilled their duties, and have requested not to seek re-commission, or have had their Commissions collected, and maintain a favorable opinion of this organization are to be considered honorably discharged.

Any Guardsmen that is found guilty of a Masonic offense in the Blue Lodge, or the Scottish Rite is considered dishonorably discharged.

Enlisted Personnel who have fulfilled their duties in a less than satisfactory manner, or have come to an unfavorable opinion of this organization and have chosen to demit are considered discharged.

Commissioned Officers, who demit from this organization prior to the terms of their Commission (Resigning their Commission) are to be considered discharged.

4.4 Commissioned Membership

Commissioned personnel shall be first, a Master of the Royal Secret in Good Standing in the Orient of Utah, second have sworn allegiance to the Supreme Council, the A&ASR, the Scots Guard, and the Principles contain herein.

Officers receive their Commissions from the Permanent General. Commissions are for a term of two-years, after which time Commissions may be renewed. Commissioned personnel will be known as Officers, or Commissioned Officers. Commissions are issued at the beginning of the Annual Term for the Battalion.

Generally, the Commandant will make recommendations for Commissioning to the Permanent General. The decision to Commission a Master of the Royal Secret is the prerogative of Permanent General, understanding that worthiness for commission must be balanced by a proven ability to lead, organize and motivate groups of people, and a demonstrated willingness to work with others to the completion of a goal.

Resignation of a Commission forfeits all rights of Guardsmen, and prohibits future enlistment or commissioned membership, except by recommendation of the Permanent General, ratified by a 2/3 majority of all Officers.

Commissions are collected by the issuing authority if a Master of the Royal Secret is Invested a Knight Commander of the Court of Honor, or when an Officer has completed their Commission (i.e. the Commission expires), and has chosen to retire by not seeking to renew his Commission. Officers whose Commissions have been collected, are not entitled to advancement or participation in the Ceremonies and Meetings of the Utah Scots Guard, and are no longer authorized to wear Uniforms or Decorations of the Scots Guard, unless otherwise directed. However, such persons may retain and use Rank/Title, and are to be greeted and addressed appropriately by all members of the Utah Scots Guard. Retired Officers do not rate a salute, and are not authorized to Salute another Officer, General, or dignitary, or to return any Salute.

4.5 Utah Scots Guard Officer Structure

Commissioned Officers (Officers), of Utah Scots Guard are categorized into two grades (progressively from lowest to highest).

4.5.1 Company Grade Officers

Second Lieutenant – One Gold Bar

First Lieutenant – One Silver Bar

Captain – Two Connecting Silver Bars

4.5.2 General Grade Officers and Billets

Commandant of the Guard – Gold Oak Leaf

Chairman of the Membership Committee – Silver Oak Leaf

Permanent General – One Star

4.6 Utah Scots Guard Officer Advancement

Advancement & Maintenance Requirements For Officers

	Notice to Learning Center		Recourse	
	TO ADVANCE TO NEXT GRADE	Per	REASON FOR RECALL	Per
2 nd Lieutenant	108	54		
1st Lieutenant			14	7
Captain	172	54	20	7

Officer advancement is measured in *facilitation*, facilitation simply enabling mission accomplishment. Facilitation is measured in hours. Facilitation hours are the hours used to complete a mission. Example: A 2nd Lieutenant may cause 9 Guardsmen to work 9 hours each. The total hours are 81 facilitation hours.

To maintain Rank, an Officer is required to meet certain yearly requirements.

Advancement Requirements are not cumulative. The 14 facilitations for 1st Lieutenant, do not count towards the 16 required for a Captain to advance.

Officers advance through Annual Review, conducted by the Commandant. Commanding Officers will present to the Commandant the annual review of all Officers under their individual command.

Should a Commandant have his Commission Collected, his successor will be chosen from the pool of all Captains who have completed the necessary requirements for advancement. Captain advancement requirements are considered as requirements for eligibility to be considered amongst the pool of Guardsmen to succeed the current Commandant.

Except where duly authorized by the Commandant or the Permanent General, The Ceremony for Commissioning occurs the evening before the Ceremony of Remembrance and Renewal.

4.7 Waivers and Changes

Yearly requirements can be waived or reduced by the Commandant, if it is determined that there is a lack of resources necessary to meet the requirements or as extenuating circumstances may dictate.

4.8 Battlefield Commissions and Advancement

The Commandant is authorized to issue Commissions to personnel, at his discretion, in order to facilitate mission accomplishment. Any advancement through the Officer ranks or to the Officer Ranks not sanctioned through the normal processes outlined in this document is considered a *Battlefield Commission*. Such advancements are considered temporary, expiring at the commencement of the next annual term.

Battlefield Commissions extend temporarily all the powers, and responsibilities of a Commissioned rank, however all duties performed that meet advancement requirements accrue at 1/2 rate while under Battlefield

Commission. Battlefield Commissioned Officers are not eligible for advancement except by Battlefield Commission.

Battlefield Commissions may be given consecutively for an indefinite number of terms.

Upon expiration of the Battlefield Commission, personnel return to their original rank.

Should retirement occur during the period of a Battlefield Commission, the retiring Officer is considered to have been fully commissioned to his rank.

Holding a Battlefield Commission does not guarantee Commissioned Status at future date.

4.9 Officer Population Ratio

For every 9 Enlisted Members, 1 Lieutenant of any grade.

For every 2 Lieutenants, 1 Captain.

Actively Commissioned Officers are given preference to fill population allotments, before new Commissions are issued. Battlefield Commissions do not ensure preference, or deference when filling population allotments.

4.10 Enlisted to Commissioned

At the prerogative of the proper agency, Enlisted members may receive Commissions, and move to the ranks of Commissioned Officers. When doing so, reunion and service hour totals are nullified.

4.11 Enlisted Membership

Enlisted personnel shall be, first a Master of the Royal Secret in the Orient of Utah, properly elected to membership in The Battalion, second, have sworn allegiance to the Scots Guard, the A&ASR, the Supreme Council, and to the Principles herein contained.

A Master of the Royal Secret shall be considered eligible for enlistment in the Utah Scots Guard after he has as been duly observed, and the members of the Company he will be joining, have voted to receive him. No Master of the Royal Secret can be considered eligible if he is not listed in Good Standing.

Enlistments are completely voluntary and may be surrendered at any time. Masters of the Royal Secret, who have previously surrendered their

enlistment, may become enlisted again, by unanimous consensus of the Commanding Officer, Executive Officer and Adjutant of the Company.

All Officers outrank Enlisted Membership, regardless of time In Service or Grade.

4.12 Utah Scots Guard Enlisted Rank Structure

Enlisted personnel shall be divided into three classes, Enlisted, Enlisted Noncommissioned Officers and Enlisted Staff Noncommissioned Officers (progressively from lowest to highest).

4.12.1 Enlisted

Private

4.12.2 Noncommissioned Officers

Sergeant

4.12.3 Staff Noncommissioned Officers

Master Sergeant

Sergeant Major

4.13 Utah Scots Guard Enlisted Advancement Table

	Hours at Learning Center to Advance to	Recommendations to Advance to
Sergeant	18	3
Master Sergeant	54	7
Sergeant Major	72	8

* Cumulative Total

** Yearly recommendations for fastest advancement

4.14 Waivers and Changes

Yearly requirements can be waived or reduced by the Commandant, if it is determined that there was a lack of resources necessary to meet the requirements.

These requirements can be changed at the decision of the Commandant, or by executive order of the General.

4.15 Utah Scots Guard Enlisted Advancement

Enlisted Personnel must advance through the ranks sequentially, as outlined in the Advancement Table for Enlisted Personnel. Only the Commandant may override this. The ceremonies of Enlisted Advancement may occur no more than once per month. Enlisted Advancement Ceremonies are conducted by each individual Company.

5.0 Powers & Organization & Duties

5.1 Permanent Offices

5.1.1 Office of the Permanent General

The Office of the Permanent General of the Utah Scots Guard is held *ex officio* by the Sovereign Grand Inspector General or Deputy of the Supreme Council for the Orient of Utah. The Permanent General is entitled to all rights and privileges of the Scots Guard, may wear a uniform, and the orders of this person override all other Officers or Personnel by virtue of his position as the Supreme Authority of the Scottish Rite in this Orient.

5.1.2 Office of the Chairman of the Membership Committee

The chairman of the Membership Committee may not issue orders, has no legal authority within the Battalion, is not authorized to wear a uniform, but is authorized to wear a sash with a silver Oak leaf upon it, does rate a salute, and he and his office are to be recognized. The Chairman of the Membership Committee will review and may reprimand the Commandant as his Superior Officer. This office retains no vote, or command authority.

5.1.3 Office of the Commandant

The Commandant will be elected by the body of Captains who have fulfilled all the requirements for advancement or in such cases where no election can occur, the Commandant will be appointed by the Permanent General. The Commandant will report to the chairman of the Membership Committee.

Except where noted above, the Commandant is the highest authority in the Battalion, and is to be recognized as the Commander-in-Chief. The decisions of the Commandant are considered final in all matters. The process of Appeal is directly to the Permanent General. The Commandant is authorized to give orders which are considered binding.

5.2 Temporary Offices

5.2.1 Establishment of Offices

Temporary Offices are appointed for the term of one year, by the Commandant. Offices may be occupied by the same Guardsmen for no more than 3 consecutive years, and no Guardsman can hold the same office for more than 6 (six) years total for every 8 (eight) years.

Terms start and end the day following the Ceremony of Remembrance and Renewal. In cases where an Office becomes unseated, the Commandant will appoint a replacement.

5.2.2 Battalion Executive Officer

The Office of the Battalion Executive Officer is the second highest authority in the Battalion. Principally charged with organizing assistance for Reunions, the Battalion Executive Officer will execute all other duties as directed by higher authority or as necessary to complete the Mission.

The Battalion Executive Officer must be a 2nd Lieutenant or higher in rank.

The Battalion Executive Officer answers directly to the Company Commanding Officer.

5.2.2 Battalion Adjutant

The Battalion Adjutant is the third highest authority in the Battalion. Principally charged with the organization and execution of plans servicing the Learning Centers, the Battalion Adjutant will execute all other duties as directed by higher authority or as necessary to complete the Mission.

The Battalion Adjutant answers directly to the Battalion Commanding Officer.

5.2.3 Battalion Sergeant Major

The Battalion Sergeant Major is principally charged with the ceremonies, ceremonial proficiency, training, education, drill, and ceremonial articles and affects of the Battalion.

The Battalion Sergeant Major is given authority over Enlisted Personnel with principal interest in maintaining and allocating resources as designated by the Battalion Executive Officer.

The Battalion Sergeant Major, must be a Sergeant Major.

5.2.4 Battalion Master Sergeant

The Battalion Master Sergeant is charged with maintaining Battalion finances and records, and will execute all other duties as directed by higher authority.

The Battalion Master Sergeant is given authority over Enlisted Personnel with principal interest in maintaining and allocating resources as designated by the Battalion Adjutant.

The Battalion Master Sergeant must be a Sergeant Major, or Master Sergeant.

5.3 Formations

There are no regular or stated formations for The Battalion. Formations may be called, at the discretion of the Commandant, or appointed authority. Formations will be conducted in accordance to the outlines laid out in the Book of Words & Forms.

5.4 Taxes & Levies

The Battalion shall levy upon each Guardsman a one time \$25.00 fee.

The Battalion shall tax each member \$5.00 per year. Retired personnel are not considered in assessing this tax.

Two years delinquency in payment will result in a summary dishonorable discharge.

5.5 Prohibitions

5.5.1 Use of Masonic Name or Emblems, and Use of Utah Scots Guard Name and Emblem

- No member of this organization shall use, or be party to the use, of such instruments listed above, as a part of title or designation of any business, firm, concern, company, associations or enterprise with out the direct authority of the Commandant or Superior Power.

5.5.2 Discussions

The body being a Masonic Organization is limited to all topics of discussion as deemed by traditional Masonic restrictions.

5.5.3 Begging Letters

No member of this organization shall give a certificate whereby any Mason or members of this organization may, in any manner, apply for relief to this body.

5.5.4 Processions

This body is authorized to participate in public processions at the discretion of the Permanent General.

5.5.5 Lending Money

This body shall not lend money to any member or Mason.

5.6 Companies

No Companies have been constituted.

6.0 Uniform Regulations

6.1 Classes

6.1.1 Military Dress

The Military Dress Uniform is described in the Book of Words & Forms.

6.1.2 Formal Dress

The Formal Dress Uniform consists of a black tuxedo of any style or cut that is well tailored. Black Tie; Red Sash; 32nd Degree Cap; Sword (as per Rank); Patent Leather, Corfram®, or highly polished leather low quarters; medals; No other pins (lapel or otherwise), adornments, or decoration are permitted with the exception of other official Masonic Medals or Awards, or Medals and Awards received during honorable Military service. The wearing of Kilts is prohibited, but trews are allowed.

6.1.3 Evening Dress

The Evening Dress Uniform is identical to the Formal Dress Uniform, except that it is white tie with white gloves and vest. Tails or Prince Charlie Jackets are acceptable and highly recommended. The wearing of Kilts is permitted. Trousers are not permitted. If kilts are worn, traditional highland shoes may be substituted for low quarters.

6.1.4 Business

The Business Uniform is identical to the Formal Dress uniform, replacing the tuxedo with a well tailored standard business suit, single or double breast. Jacket or coat, with tie, and slacks is also acceptable provided that suitable attention is paid to tailoring, color, and balance. No jacket that is the authorized uniform of another Masonic body is permitted.

Swords, Medals and Awards are not permitted with the Business Uniform. Rank Insignia are worn upon the Sash as described in the Book of Words and Forms.

Unless otherwise noted, the Uniform of the Day will be the Business Uniform.

7.0 Conduct

7.1 The Principles

The Principles of The Battalion are as follows. All members of The Battalion, are required to swear and Oath of Fidelity to these Principles, and uphold them in all aspects of the lives.

7.2 HONOR

responsibility to duty above self, including, but not limited to:

7.2.1 Integrity.

Demonstrating the highest standards of consistent adherence to right, legal and ethical conduct.

7.2.2 Responsibility.

Personally accepting the consequences for decisions and actions. Coaching right decisions of subordinates. A chain is only as strong as the weakest individual link, but a battalion of Guardsmen is more like a cable. Together we are stronger than any individual strand, but one strand may hold us together in a crisis if it's strong enough. One Guardsmen taking responsibility for a situation may save the day.

7.2.3 Honesty.

Overt honesty in word and action and clarifying possible misunderstanding or misrepresentation caused by silence or inaction when you should speak up. Respecting other's property and demonstrating fairness in all actions. Guardsmen do not lie, cheat, or steal.

7.2.4 Tradition.

Demonstrating respect for the customs, courtesies, and traditions developed over many years for good reason. Respect for the heritage and traditions of others, especially those we encounter in duty around the world.

7.3 COURAGE

Moral, mental, and physical strength to resist opposition, face danger, and endure hardship, including, but not limited to:

7.3.1 Self-Discipline.

Guardsmen hold themselves responsible for their own actions and others responsible for their actions. Guardsmen are committed to maintaining physical, mental, and emotional health, to fitness and

7.3.2 Patriotism.

Devotion to and defense of one's country. The freely chosen, informed willingness to support and defend the Principles laid out in the Constitution of the United States.

7.3.3 Loyalty.

Steady reliability to do one's duty in Service.

7.3.4 Valor.

Boldness and determination in facing danger in battle, and the daily commitment to excellence and honesty in actions small and large.

7.4 COMMITMENT

The promise or pledge to complete a worthy goal by worthy means, which requires identification with that goal and demonstrated actions to support that goal, including, but not limited to:

7.4.1 Competence.

Maintaining, and improving one's skill level to support the team. Dedication to growing toward a standard of excellence second to none.

7.4.2 Teamwork.

Individual effort in support of other team members in accomplishing the team's mission. Guardsmen take care of their own. All worthwhile accomplishments are the result of a team effort.

7.4.3 Selflessness.

Guardsmen take care of their subordinates, their families, their fellow guardsmen, and themselves. The welfare of others, and those

education, skill, self-esteem, and quality of life for our community.

7.4.5 Spiritual Heritage.

The U.S. Constitution, the Pledge of Allegiance, and the creeds that guide our nation recognize the value of religious and spiritual and moral heritage of individuals and base our understanding of rights and duties on the endowment of all people, by God, with the inalienable rights of life, liberty, and the pursuit of happiness. Guardsmen maintain spiritual health and growth to nurture enduring values and acquire a source of strength required for success in battle and the ability to endure hardship.